

As was noted in the previous section, there was a sharp drop in activity rates for women aged 20-59 years in 1963. Table 9.8 shows the distribution of employed females of all ages by employment status at the censuses taken in 1953, 1963 and 1971. Sharp decreases are noticeable in the case of those categorised as workers on own account and unpaid family workers in 1963.

TABLE 9.8 : EMPLOYMENT STATUS OF WOMEN 1953-1971

Status	1953		1963		1971	
	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Paid Employee.	484745	66.90	544125	83.11	599901	77.54
Employer	9200	1.27	3757	0.57	5543	0.72
Own Account Worker	136742	18.87	56422	8.62	82935	10.72
Unpaid Family Worker	93922	12.96	42742	6.53	85242	11.02
Status Unspecified	-	-	7672	1.17	-	-
Total	724609	100	654718	100	773621	100

This decline in the activity rate has to be counterbalanced by an increase in the rate of those economically inactive. The principal activity of females aged 20-59 years who are economically inactive is "attending to home duties". The proportion of those attending to home duties was 67.6 percent in 1963 as compared with 59.8 percent in 1971. It would therefore appear that the short fall in 1963 of women in the economically active category was due to a shift of workers from the category of "own account workers" and "unpaid family workers" to those attending to home duties in the economically inactive category. In 1963 the Census was taken in July of that year whereas the Censuses of 1946 and 1953 were taken in the month of March and the Census of 1971 was taken in the month of October. The information recorded at these censuses would have been collected at the preliminary censuses held a month or so earlier in each case. The information for the 1963 Census would therefore have been collected in the month of June which is a slack month for agricultural activity whereas in the case of the other three censuses information was collected in months during which agricultural activity is at its peak. A partial explanation for the drop in the activity rate in 1963, therefore may be that women who are seasonal workers were reported as attending to home duties if at the time of the census they are not actually at work.

Table 9.9 shows the distribution of employment status of women in agricultural occupations only.

TABLE 9.9 : EMPLOYMENT STATUS OF WOMEN IN AGRICULTURAL OCCUPATIONS, 1953 - 1971

Status	1953		1963		1971	
	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Paid Employee	337722	79.35	356371	86.66	355529	71.82
Employer	3145	0.74	925	0.23	1281	0.25
Own Account Worker	35185	8.27	19785	4.81	60195	12.16
Unpaid Family Worker	49548	11.64	33940	8.26	77954	15.74
Unspecified	-	-	136	0.03	-	-
Total	425600	100	411157	100	494959	100